

DURGA DASGUPTA

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RESEARCH PROFILE

Research Associate candidate with a background in History, specialising in craft studies, material culture, and folk storytelling traditions in India. Experienced in archival research, secondary research, qualitative analysis, and cultural documentation. Skilled in building research repositories, narrative frameworks, and structured datasets to support documentary, podcast, and media production. Strong interest in community-based storytelling, indigenous knowledge systems, and traditional craft practices.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Indian Crafts & Textile Histories
 - Folk Storytelling & Oral Traditions
 - Material Culture & Production Practices
 - Cultural Anthropology & Visual Culture
 - Documentary Research & Narrative Development
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RESEARCH SKILLS & METHODS

- **Research Methods:** Qualitative research, secondary research, archival research, literature review
 - **Analysis:** Thematic analysis, comparative analysis, historical interpretation, cultural analysis
 - **Documentation:** Research documentation, data organisation, metadata tagging, repository building
 - **Story Development:** Narrative building, script research, documentary research, storytelling frameworks
 - **Tools:** Digital archives, bibliographic databases, Canva, Microsoft Word, AI research tools
 - **Keywords:** Ethnography (basic exposure), craft documentation, oral histories, cultural mapping
 - **Languages:** English, Bengali, Hindi
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RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Weavers Studio — *Lead Research Coordinator & Editorial Assistant*

May 2025 – Dec 2025 | Remote

- Conducted secondary and archival research on Bengali indigo and indigo textile production, focusing on craft history, labour practices, and material culture
 - Analysed traditional production techniques, craft processes, and regional textile practices within historical and ecological contexts
 - Produced 5+ structured research reports and literature syntheses for exhibitions and cultural storytelling
 - Built and maintained a research repository and bibliographic database, improving research efficiency by ~30%
 - Developed narrative frameworks for public-facing outputs, aligning research with exhibition and media storytelling goals
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Mercuri Magazine — *Staff Researcher & Editorial Lead*

Jul 2025 – Dec 2025 | Remote

- Conducted qualitative and comparative research on cultural, historical, and media narratives
 - Performed literature review and trend analysis to identify gaps in storytelling and content strategy
 - Developed research-backed editorial frameworks for newsletters and long-form content
 - Translated research insights into accessible narratives for diverse audiences
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Empower Desk — *Digital Content & Engagement Lead*

2025 – Present | Remote

- Created research-informed knowledge resources and communication toolkits
 - Managed community engagement and discourse around social and cultural themes
 - Applied data-driven insights and audience analysis to improve communication strategies
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PROJECTS

Research-Based Documentary (Ajanta) — *Animator & Content Creator*

2024

- Conducted historical and visual culture research on Ajanta's material and environmental history
 - Developed a research-driven narrative and storyboard for an animated documentary
 - Translated academic research into visual storytelling for public audiences (1000+ viewers)
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Exhibition Research & Curation Support — *Birla Academy of Art and Culture*

Display Team Head | 2024

- Applied research-based categorisation and cultural mapping to organise 700+ artworks
 - Used audience insights and spatial analysis to enhance engagement
 - Supported curatorial research and exhibition design processes
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EDUCATION

Jadavpur University — B.A. (Honours), History (*2025 – Present*)

- Relevant Areas: Cultural History, Material Culture, Social Theory

Patha Bhavan — High School Diploma

- Top 25 Rank Holder in State | History & Sociology